

iPerform 3D

Shell out \$19.95 for the iPerform 3D that lets you play the song from any angle, zooming into the action, slowing down and speeding up pace without affecting the pitch of the song

OCZ Revo Drive 3 x2

Anandtech has done an in-depth preview of this monster 960GB SSD. Check it out at <http://goo.gl/zhi4h>

External HDD



FLASH DRIVES

	Under 32 GB							32 GB and above			
Brand	Kingston	ADATA	Transcend	Silicon Power	Apacer	ADATA	ZipMem	Kingston	Silicon Power	Apacer	Kingston
Model Name	Data Traveller	Superior S102	JF 700	Luxmini 920	AH 130	Superior S101	-	Data Traveller	Blaze B10	AH 552	Data Traveller 410
Price (₹)	3,500	1,240	1,300	1,050	1,250	560	600	7,599	2,850	5,345	3,379
Capacity	16	16	8	16	8	8	10	64	32	32	32
Cost Per GB (₹)	234.742	84.354	176.630	70.423	167.560	74.468	62.176	127.436	92.293	181.494	112.296
Grand Total (Out Of 100)	64.93	42.77	34.74	26.21	20.58	21.56	19.63	69.55	41.61	81.52	25.37
Specifications											
HDD capacity (unformatted) (GB)	14.91	14.7	7.36	14.91	7.46	7.52	9.65	59.63	30.88	29.45	30.09
Interface	USB 3.0	USB 3.0	USB 3.0	USB 2.0	USB 2.0	USB 2.0	USB 2.0	USB 3.0	USB 3.0	USB 3.0	USB 2.0
Performance											
HD Tune Pro 4.0.1											
Average Read (MBps)	82.3	66.7	51.8	30.9	21.8	29.7	18.8	83.1	67.9	121.1	31.1
Access Time (Read, ms)	0.712	0.404	0.511	0.737	0.607	0.664	0.706	0.692	0.428	0.742	0.774
Read Burst Speed (MBps)	46.2	56	45.9	31.2	23.8	20.8	19.8	46.8	55.8	69.3	31.8
CPU Usage (In %)	1.6	1.5	1.3	1.9	1.3	1.5	1.4	2	1.5	2.4	1.8
Random Access (Read 1 MB)											
Operations per sec (IOPS)	76	64	50	30	22	23	18	77	65	107	29
Average Access Time (ms)	13.04	15.4	19.76	32.42	45.16	42.66	52.65	12.95	15.24	9.33	33.53
SiSoft Sandra 2010											
Drive Index, Read (MBps)	84.33	66.65	51.75	30.26	22	23.67	18.85	85.63	67.87	116.7	31.2
Access Time, read (microsecs)	695	94	101	190	107	42	180	688	256	474	337
Real World Tests (Higher is better)											
File Write 4 GB Single File (MB/s)	62.77	19.41	14.37	16.71	9.52	8.69	12.88	48.76	20.68	71.17	18.81
File Write Test Assorted 4 GB File (MB/s)	39.38	8.25	7.08	13.17	6.81	5.12	9.66	53.19	6.18	42.3	9.86
Read Test Single 4 GB File (MB/s)	83.03	65.01	50.19	31.03	22.61	21.67	18.78	84.34	66.06	115.51	31.03
Read Test Assorted 4 GB File (MB/s)	72.68	61.13	48.76	29.46	21.78	20.96	18.7	74.47	62.06	100.98	29.92

We decided to call in for pen drives which were 8 GB and above as anything below that just does not cut it with us. Here too we got a lot of participating USB 3.0 drives. There were lots of interesting form factors on display here. The bulky rugged Kingston Data Traveller Ultimate drives to the tiny Apacer AH

130 which is almost inconspicuous if it weren't for the bright orange colour. Silicon Power Blaze B10 has a heat resistant paint on its outer cover, which changes colour when the drive heats up. Kingston Data Traveller 410 has an interesting swivel design along with the classy rubberised finish on the drive.

Stream S10 and Armor A80 but the Diamond D10 had the lowest cost per GB amongst them all. We also awarded the Editor's Pick to Hitachi Touro Mobile Pro for its superlative performance in this segment. It gave a performance that was 90 per cent that of the Best Performer. It also has an additional cloud storage option which gave it an edge over the others.

Portable Drives over 750GB: The ADATA Classic

CH11 won the Best Buy here thanks to its lower cost per GB. Seagate GoFlex 1.5TB drive performed better but lost out on the pricing.

Flash Drives of capacity 32GB and over: Apacer AH 552 won the Best Performer across all the pen drives that we got. It gave impressive scores of over 100 MB/s for read tests. Kingston Data Traveller 64GB drive won the Best Buy for its superior price to performance ratio as com-

pared to the other two drives. If you are not looking at best performance for your price, the Silicon Power Blaze B10 makes for an economical buy.

Flash drives under 32 GB: ADATA Superior S102 won the Best Buy in the under 32GB flash drive category for its good performance and comparatively cheaper cost per GB.

Final Words

The mere fact that all the awards were swept by USB 3.0

drives points to an important conclusion - investing in a USB 2.0 drive now is pointless. Of course the prices will keep dropping, but as was seen above, the price per GB difference between the USB 2.0 drives and USB 3.0 drives was not very high. The fact that USB 3.0 drives are backward compatible with USB 2.0 ports means that you can future proof your investment if you do not have a USB 3 drive on your board just yet. ■